

Philipp Hilbert. *AI-native product operator who ships from idea to production.*

Positioning, a hands-on product manager who maps use cases, builds working prototypes with Cursor and Claude Code, and drives AI projects through to production across diverse business domains.

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§ WHY FLEX CAPITAL

FLEX sits at an unusual intersection: PE-level access to a dozen different software businesses simultaneously, combined with a mandate to actually improve them operationally rather than just govern them financially. The job description explicitly names Cursor and Claude Code as daily instruments, not aspirational bullet points – that matches exactly how I already work. The role of translator between technical teams and portfolio stakeholders is one I have occupied at Rohde & Schwarz, the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, and Emil Group, always as the person who made ambiguous requirements buildable without losing the business intent. *That is exactly the compound leverage I am looking for: one person's product judgment applied across multiple companies at once.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Cursor / VSCode**, in-repo prototyping and feature iteration
- **Claude Code**, agentic in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GPT**, requirements drafting, edge-case enumeration, stakeholder summaries
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for user-facing PoCs
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototype work

- **n8n**, multi-agent and automation workflow orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder presentations
 - **GitHub Copilot**, daily development assist across Python and JavaScript
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Redpanda, Django, AngularJS, Ionic, MicroStrategy, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

DEV AGENT FRAMEWORK & CRYPTO BACKTEST ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal infrastructure project combining a custom agentic dev framework with a backtesting engine for crypto market strategies.

- Builds and orchestrates multi-agent loops for automated code generation, testing, and iterative refinement using file-queue-based agent coordination.
 - Architecture: Python-based agent orchestration with modular tool integrations, designed for low-latency iteration cycles without manual handoffs.
 - Informs hands-on understanding of LLM reliability, prompt failure modes, and where agentic loops break under real conditions.
 - Directly relevant to FLEX's mandate of building AI PoCs quickly and honestly: I know from personal production experience where AI-assisted development delivers and where it needs a human backstop.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FLEX CAPITAL

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Conduct structured intake conversations with the Operating Partner AI and two or three portfolio teams currently running or scoping AI projects, mapping where use cases stall – typically at the gap between a compelling demo and a production-ready spec.

WEEK 2

Slice and prototype.

Pick the highest-leverage stalled use case, write a sharp one-pager scoping user value and technical feasibility, and build a minimal PoC with Cursor or Lovable to make the trade-offs concrete for the portfolio team's engineers.

WEEK 3+

Ship and replicate.

Drive the PoC toward a production-ready handoff, document the pattern, and identify which other portfolio companies face the same problem class – so the second implementation costs a fraction of the first.

I COVER LETTER

Dear FLEX Capital team,

I am applying for the AI Product Manager role because the description maps cleanly to the work I already do. At Rohde & Schwarz I took an AI data platform from fragmented requirements to production in a government defence context, delivering autonomous feature sets end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout – while coordinating across architects, data scientists, backend engineers, and QA. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a public analytics platform and introduced Dagster-based ETL pipelines and Kubernetes migrations. At Emil Group I re-established delivery discipline inside a broken 17-person team, split it into functional Scrum units, and rebuilt client trust through structured weekly product workshops. These are not case studies I observed from the outside; I was the person accountable for the outcome.

The specific combination FLEX names – product thinking, technical proximity, and rapid prototyping with Cursor and Claude Code – is how I operate daily. I use Claude Code for in-repo refactors and spec generation, Cursor for iterative feature builds, Lovable for front-end PoCs that make trade-offs visible to non-technical stakeholders, and n8n for multi-agent workflow orchestration. I have also built my own agentic dev framework and crypto backtesting

engine, which gives me grounded, failure-mode-aware experience with LLM-assisted development that goes beyond reading documentation.

The cross-portfolio structure at FLEX is genuinely interesting to me. I have worked in InsurTech, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, and payment infrastructure – not by accident but because I find the pattern-matching across industries intellectually productive. A PM who has seen how data quality problems manifest in a defence AI context and how sprint discipline collapses in a scaling InsurTech startup is better positioned to diagnose and unblock a new portfolio company quickly. That breadth is usually a liability in a single-product company; at FLEX it is the asset.

My Python foundation is solid enough to build working PoCs and to read and critique production code, though I am not a full-stack developer. I am transparent about that boundary. What I bring is the ability to make technical options legible to business stakeholders, write requirements that engineers can act on without a second meeting, and prototype fast enough that discussions move from hypotheticals to concrete artifacts. That is where the FLEX role sits, and it is where I do my best work.

I am based in Berlin, immediately available for a conversation, and happy to bring a short prototype or requirements document as a practical work sample if that would make the evaluation more concrete.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable software systems, across AI platforms, analytics infrastructure, regulated B2B SaaS, and healthcare. Comfortable in ambiguous, high-pressure environments where requirements are incomplete and teams need clarity to move. AI-native in practice: Cursor, Claude Code, Lovable, n8n, and LLM-assisted development are part of daily delivery, not aspirational tools. Strong technical fluency enables direct unblocking of engineering problems without always routing through a developer.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Use-case scoping from raw idea to dev-ready specification

- Rapid PoC delivery with Cursor, Claude Code, Lovable, and Python
 - Cross-functional alignment across engineering, data science, QA, and business
 - Sprint discipline, backlog management, and team restructuring under pressure
 - LLM stack fluency: RAG concepts, agentic workflows, evals, prompt failure modes
 - Translating technical constraints into business-legible trade-offs
 - Production-grade delivery with GitOps, Kubernetes, and CI/CD pipelines
 - Multi-industry pattern recognition across InsurTech, defence AI, public sector, healthcare
 - Low-ego, high-agency operating style in founder and PE-portfolio environments
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation, testing, and GitOps-based rollout on a government defence AI platform (FCAS)
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated multimodal datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)
- Unblocked an infrastructure-level OpenShift issue independently; delivered in one week a feature engineers had not shipped in over a year
- Led a cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA; coordinated with multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Introduced Dagster-based automated ETL and indicator generation pipelines for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor labour market analytics platform
- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin features
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production on a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, accountable Scrum units with ownership and deputy structures
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Rebuilt client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals across iOS and Android, covering digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Maintained stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity around legacy APIs and external database constraints

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

- **Qcrypt AG (2016–2018), Product Owner:** Quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true-RNG hardware. Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture. Also served as Deputy IT Security Officer. Setup time under two minutes, no technical knowledge required.
- **Kvitt Payment Solutions (2013–2018), Founder & CFO:** Group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone. Full UX/UI design, PSP integration, and mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.
- **AOK Health Insurance / ITSCare (2019–2020), Proxy Product Owner:** Migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies.
- **Bundesdruckerei / RKI (2021), Product Owner:** COVID-19 data platform projects DIM and DESH. Secure data structures and identity management.

- **Smart Soil Technologies (2016–2021), Co-Founder / CDO / CFO:** Intelligent fertiliser and substrate solutions for vertical indoor farming. Digital tooling, financial planning, investor relations, ERP introduction.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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